



(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Holtmaat

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(54) **RUDBECKIA PLANT NAMED ‘RUDHT17’**
(50) Latin Name: *Rudbeckia hirta*
Varietal Denomination: **RUDHT17**
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See application file for complete search history.
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(57) **ABSTRACT**
A new and distinct cultivar of *Rudbeckia* plant named
‘RUDHT17’, characterized by its compact, broadly upright
and mounded plant habit; freely branching growth habit;
freely flowering habit; single-type inflorescences with yel-
low orange to grayed orange and greyed purple to brown
bi-colored ray florets positioned above the foliar plane on
strong peduncles; and good garden and container perfor-
mance.

2 Drawing Sheets

1

Botanical designation: *Rudbeckia hirta*.
Cultivar denomination: ‘RUDHT17’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Rudbeckia* plant, botanically known as *Rudbeckia hirta*,
commonly referred to as Black-eyed Susan, and hereinafter
referred to by the name ‘RUDHT17’.

The new *Rudbeckia* plant is a product of a planned
breeding program conducted by the Inventor in Zuidwolde,
The Netherlands. The objective of the breeding program is
to create new compact *Rudbeckia* plants with numerous
attractive inflorescences.

The new *Rudbeckia* plant originated from a cross-pollina-
tion made by the Inventor in Zuidwolde, The Netherlands
in July, 2015 of two unnamed proprietary seedling selections
of *Rudbeckia hirta*, not patented. The new *Rudbeckia* plant
was discovered and selected by the Inventor as a single
flowering plant from within the progeny of the stated
cross-pollination in a controlled environment in Zuidwolde,
The Netherlands in July, 2016.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Rudbeckia* by in vitro
meristem culture in a controlled greenhouse environment in
Zuidwolde, The Netherlands since March, 2017 has shown
that the unique features of this new *Rudbeckia* are stable and
reproduced true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

Plants of the new *Rudbeckia* have not been observed
under all possible combinations of environmental conditions
and cultural practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat
with variations in environmental conditions such as tem-
perature and light intensity, without, however, any variance
in genotype.

2

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
are determined to be the unique characteristics of
‘RUDHT17’. These characteristics in combination distin-
guish ‘RUDHT17’ as a new and distinct *Rudbeckia* plant:

1. Compact, broadly upright and mounded plant habit.
2. Freely branching growth habit.
3. Freely flowering habit.
4. Single-type inflorescences with yellow orange to
grayed orange and greyed purple to brown bi-colored
ray florets positioned above the foliar plane on strong
peduncles.
5. Good garden and container performance.

Plants of the new *Rudbeckia* differ from plants of the
parent selections in the following characteristics in plant
habit as plants of the new *Rudbeckia* are more compact and
uniform than plants of the parent selections.

Plants of the new *Rudbeckia* can be compared to *Rud-
beckia hirta* X *Echinacea purpurea* ‘ET-RDB 02’, disclosed
in U.S. Plant Pat. No. 25,243. Plants of the new *Rudbeckia*
differ primarily from plants of ‘ET-RDB 02’ in the following
characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Rudbeckia* are more compact than
plants of ‘ET-RDB 02’.
2. Plants of the new *Rudbeckia* and ‘ET-RDB 02’ differ in
ray floret color as plants of ‘ET-RDB 02’ have yellow,
orange and reddish-colored ray florets.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying photographs illustrate the overall
appearance of the new *Rudbeckia* showing the colors as true
as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproduc-
tions of this type. Colors in the photographs may differ
slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical
description which accurately describe the colors of the new
Rudbeckia.

The photograph on the first sheet comprises a side perspective view of a typical flowering plant of 'RUDHT17' grown in a container.

The photograph at the top of the second sheet is a close-up view of a typical flowering plant of 'RUDHT17'.

The photograph at the bottom of the second sheet is a close-up view of typical leaves of 'RUDHT17'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown in 19-cm containers during the late summer and early autumn in an outdoor nursery in Zuidwolde, The Netherlands and under cultural conditions typical of commercial *Rudbeckia* production. During the production of the plants, day temperatures ranged from 18° C. to 30° C. and night temperatures ranged from 6° C. to 18° C. Plants were 18 weeks old when the photographs were taken and 17 weeks old when the detailed description was taken. In the following description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 2015 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Rudbeckia hirta* 'RUDHT17'.

Parentage:

Female, or seed, parent.—Unnamed proprietary seedling selection of *Rudbeckia hirta*, not patented.

Male, or pollen, parent.—Unnamed proprietary seedling selection of *Rudbeckia hirta*, not patented.

Propagation:

Type.—By in vitro meristem culture.

Time to initiate roots.—About ten days at soil temperatures about 15° C. and ambient temperatures about 20° C.

Time to produce a rooted young plants.—About 30 to 35 days at soil temperatures about 15° C. and ambient temperatures about 20° C.

Root description.—Medium in thickness; fleshy; typically white in color, actual color of the roots is dependent on substrate composition, water quality, fertilizers, substrate temperature and physiological age of roots.

Rooting habit.—Freely branching; medium density.

Plant description:

Plant and growth habit.—Herbaceous perennial; compact, broadly upright and mounded plant habit; strong and freely branching growth habit with about six primary lateral branches each with about three secondary lateral branches; dense and bushy appearance; moderately vigorous growth habit; medium growth rate.

Plant height.—About 47 cm.

Plant width.—About 39.9 cm.

Lateral branches.—Length: About 20.5 cm. Diameter: About 6 mm. Internode length: About 4.1 cm. Angle: Primary lateral branches are upright to about 15° from vertical and secondary lateral branches are about 30° from primary lateral branches axis. Strength: Moderately strong. Texture and luster: Densely pubescent; moderately glossy. Lenticels: Length: About 0.3 mm. Width: About 0.1 mm. Color: Close to N186C. Color: Developing branches, close to 143B; developed branches, close to 144A with axillary stripes, close to 143A, and at the nodes, close to N186C.

Leaf description:

Arrangement.—Alternate, simple; sessile.

Length.—About 16.7 cm.

Width.—About 5.8 cm.

Shape.—Obovate to elliptic.

Apex.—Bluntly acute.

Base.—Truncate to cuneate.

Margin.—Serrate.

Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces.—Pubescent, rough; matte.

Venation pattern.—Pinnate.

Color.—Developing leaves, upper surface: Close to 137A. Developing leaves, lower surface: Close to 137C. Fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Close to NN137A; venation, close to 145C. Fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 137C; venation, close to 146A.

Inflorescence description:

Type and arrangement.—Single-type inflorescence form with ovate to elliptic-shaped ray florets and tubular disc florets; inflorescences borne on terminal and axillary peduncles above and beyond the foliar plane on strong peduncles; ray and disc florets arranged acropetally on a capitulum.

Fragrance.—None detected.

Flowering season.—Plants begin flowering about 100 days after planting; long flowering period, plants flower continuously during the late summer to late autumn in The Netherlands.

Inflorescence longevity.—Good postproduction longevity with inflorescences lasting about two to five weeks on the plant; inflorescences not persistent.

Quantity of inflorescences.—Freely flowering habit, typically about 18 developing and fully developed inflorescences at one time.

Inflorescence buds.—Height: About 2.5 cm. Diameter: About 2.3 cm. Shape: Broadly ovate. Texture and luster: Densely pubescent; matte. Color: Close to 174A to 174B.

Inflorescences.—Diameter: About 13.2 cm. Depth (height): About 3.2 cm. Diameter of disc: About 3.2 cm. Receptacle height: About 1 cm. Receptacle diameter: About 1.2 cm. Receptacle shape: Broadly ovate to nearly deltoid. Receptacle color: Close to 155C.

Ray florets.—Quantity and arrangement: About 20 per inflorescence arranged in a single whorl. Length: About 5.9 cm. Width: About 2.4 cm. Shape: Ovate to elliptic. Apex: Praemorse to emarginate. Base: Cuneate. Margin: Entire. Aspect: When developing, upright and when fully opened, perpendicular to peduncle axis. Texture and luster, upper surface: Smooth, glabrous; velvety; matte. Texture and luster, lower surface: Densely pubescent; slightly velvety; matte. Color: When opening, upper surface: Distally, close to between 23A and 167A; proximally, close to 200A tinged with close to N186C. When opening, lower surface: Close to 152D and 166A to 166B. Fully opened, upper surface: Distally, close to between 23A and 167B; proximally, close to between 183B and 200B. Fully opened, lower surface: Close to 163A, 165B and 166B.

Disc florets.—Quantity and arrangement: About 700 per inflorescence arranged in a spiral of about 15 whorls. Length: About 8.5 mm. Width: About 4 mm.

Shape: Lower 85% fused and tubular, elongated. Apex: Acute. Aspect: Upright. Texture and luster: Smooth, glabrous; glossy. Color, when opening and fully opened, inner and outer surfaces: Distally, close to between N186C and 200A; proximally, close to 155A.

Phyllaries.—Quantity and arrangement: About 24 per inflorescence arranged in about two whorls. Length: About 3 cm. Width: About 8 mm. Shape: Narrowly oblong. Apex: Bluntly acute to obtuse. Base: Broadly cuneate. Margin: Entire. Texture and luster, upper and lower surfaces: Densely pubescent; matte. Color, upper surface: Close to between 137A and 143A. Color, lower surface: Close to 143B.

Peduncles.—Length: About 9.9 cm. Diameter: About 5 mm. Strength: Strong. Aspect: Mostly upright. Texture and luster: Densely pubescent; moderately glossy. Color: Close to 144A with axillary stripes, close to 143A.

Reproductive organs.—Androecium (present only on disc florets): Quantity per disc floret: About five. Filament length: About 2 mm. Filament color: Close to 155A. Anther shape: Narrowly oblong. Anther

length: About 2.5 mm. Anther width: About 0.5 mm. Anther color: Close to 200A. Pollen amount: Scarce. Pollen color: Close to 17B. Gynoecium (present only on disc florets): Pistil length: About 6 mm. Style length: About 4.5 mm. Style color: Close to 155A. Stigma diameter: About 3 mm. Stigma shape: Cleft, decurrent. Stigma color: Close to between 200A and 202A. Ovary color: Close to NN155B.

Seeds and fruits.—Seed and fruit production has not been observed on plants of the new *Rudbeckia* to date.

Disease & pest resistance: Plants of the new *Rudbeckia* have not been observed to be resistant to pathogens and pests common to *Rudbeckia* plants.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Rudbeckia* have been observed to have good garden performance and to tolerate wind, rain, high temperatures about 35° C. and to be suitable for USDA Hardiness Zones 5 to 10.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Rudbeckia* plant named 'RUDHT17' as illustrated and described.

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